WCCCD Forms Center: Purchasing Module

Phase 3 detail: secure intake for RFPs, RFQs, and bids

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This brief shows how Phase 3 of the WCCCD Forms Center would work if WCCCD builds RFP intake internally. Joining MITN is a simpler alternative and is laid out below. Either way, requisitions, POs, and payment stay in Banner.

Required controls

- Verified vendor identity, a system timestamp, and an emailed receipt with a submission ID.
- Proposals sealed until opening. No one, Purchasing included, sees them early.
- Vendors never see each other's submissions, and every access is logged.

How it works if built internally

Step	What happens	Tool
1. Register	Vendor completes a form: company, contact, email, RFP number. Registration closes one to two days before the deadline.	Microsoft Forms
2. Sign in	Vendor is invited as a guest and signs in with a one-time code sent to that email.	Entra guest access
3. Upload	Vendor uploads to a private folder only they can see.	SharePoint
4. Seal and receipt	File moves to a sealed library, gets a system time and submission ID, and the vendor receives an emailed receipt.	Power Automate
5. Close	At the deadline, vendor access is removed. Late files are flagged and kept for the record.	Power Automate
6. Open and evaluate	Purchasing opens submissions per procedure. Evaluators get access and score independently in a scoring list. Every access is logged.	SharePoint, Purview
7. Award	Award is recorded and the RFP record is linked to the Banner requisition and PO.	SharePoint, Banner

Fallback. If a flow fails on deadline day, Purchasing emails registered vendors a pre-built upload link and sends receipts by hand. A Purchasing mailbox covers a SharePoint outage.

Alternative: join MITN

MITN is a Michigan public purchasing group on BidNet Direct, used by Lansing CC, Mott CC, and Mid Michigan College. It handles advertising, vendor registration, sealed electronic submission, addenda, and awards, and is marketed as no cost to agencies.

- **Simpler.** Nothing to build or support, and Michigan vendors are already registered.
- **Trade-offs.** The bid record lives outside WCCCD's systems, and the link to Banner stays manual. Confirm what evaluation tools it includes.

Other options considered

- **Hosted bid platform (Bonfire, OpenGov).** Annual subscription. A fallback if neither path works.
- **Power Pages portal.** Rejected: per-user licensing and a larger build for no added benefit at WCCCD's volume.

Purchasing decisions needed

- Policy on electronic submission, late bids, and the registration cutoff.
- Opening procedure and records retention for proposals and evaluations.

Decision requested

Choose the path for RFP intake: join MITN, or build the module above. Either way, Purchasing names a business owner and settles the decisions above. If building, Information Security reviews guest access and the sealed library before testing begins.

See the full Forms Center package online

Plan, slide deck, clickable prototype, and design guide, all in one place.

ecrutch1.github.io/WCCCD-FORMS-CENTER